



Kirk MacKinnon

Post-doctoral Fellow

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📍 Center for Genomics and Systems Biology, NYU

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🌐 [kirkmackinnon](https://github.com/kirkmackinnon)

About me

I am a molecular & computational biologist trained in the preparation and analysis of RNA-seq, ChIP-seq, DAP-seq, ATAC-seq, and GWA datasets. I am passionate about learning and staying up to date with the literature. I have a proven performance history of competent, publication worthy analyses in several different sequencing related disciplines.

Education

2015-2021	Doctorate of Philosophy Amherst, MA	UMASS Amherst
2011-2015	Bachelor of Science in Biology Amherst, MA	UMASS Amherst

Research Experience

2022 - Current	Inferring and validating cell-specific gene regulatory networks to bridge the gap between model and crop research. Postdoc	Coruzzi Lab
2015-2021	Investigating the transcriptional regulation of growth in the model grass <i>Brachypodium distachyon</i> . Ph.D	Hazen Lab
2013-2015	Conducted time-lapse image analysis of <i>Brachypodium distachyon</i> in response to altered abiotic conditions. Research Assistant	Hazen Lab

Teaching

2018-2020	Introductory Biology 1 (BIO 151). Graduate Teaching Assistant
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Awards

2021	Howard E. and Margaret E. Barr Bigelow Memorial Scholarship.
2021	Lotta M. Crabtree Fellowship in Production Agriculture.
2020	Center for Agriculture, Food and the Environment Fellowship.
2019	Lotta M. Crabtree Fellowship in Production Agriculture.
2018	Center for Agriculture, Food and the Environment Fellowship.
2015	Outstanding Biology Research Award.
2013-2015	UMass Amherst Dean's List.

Publications

- 2021 Touch-triggered bZIP translocation regulates elongation and secondary wall biosynthesis
Joshua H. Coomey, Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Ian W. McCahill, Pubudu P. Handakumbura, Gina M. Trabucco, Jessica Mazzola, Nicole A. Leblanc, Rithany Kheam, Miriam Hernandez-Romero, Kerrie Barry, Lifeng Liu, Ji E. Lee, John P. Vogel, Ronan C. O'Malley, James J. Chambers, Samuel P. Hazen
• <https://doi.org/10.1101/2021.02.03.429573>
- 2020 Changes in ambient temperature are the prevailing cue in determining *Brachypodium distachyon* diurnal gene regulation
New Phytologist
Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Benjamin J. Cole, Chang Yu, Joshua H. Coomey, Nolan T. Hartwick, Marie-Stanislas Remigereau, Tomás Duffy, Todd P. Michael, Steve A. Kay, Samuel P. Hazen
• <https://doi.org/10.1111/nph.16507>
- 2018 *SECONDARY WALL ASSOCIATED MYB 1* is a positive regulator of secondary cell wall thickening in *Brachypodium distachyon* and is not found in the Brassicaceae
The Plant Journal
Pubudu P. Handakumbura, Kathryn Brow, Ian P. Whitney, Kangmei Zhao, Karen A. Sanguinet, Scott J. Lee, Jennifer Olins, Sandra P. Romero-Gamboa, Michael J. Harrington, Carlisle J. Bascom, Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Michael T. Veling, Lifeng Liu, Ji E. Lee, John P. Vogel, Ronan C. O'Malley, Magdalena Bezanilla, Laura E. Bartley, Samuel P. Hazen
• <https://doi.org/10.1111/tpj.14047>
- 2018 Secondary Wall Regulating NACs Differentially Bind at the Promoter at a CELLULOSE SYNTHASE A4 Cis-eQTL
Frontiers in Plant Science
Jennifer R. Olins, Li Lin, Scott J. Lee, Gina M. Trabucco, Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Samuel P. Hazen
• <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpls.2018.01895>
- 2014 Daily Changes in Temperature, Not the Circadian Clock, Regulate Growth Rate in *Brachypodium distachyon*
PLOS ONE
Dominick A. Matos, Benjamin J. Cole, Ian P. Whitney, Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Steve A. Kay, Samuel P. Hazen
• <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0100072>

Conference Presentations

Talks

- 2018 Exploring Diurnal Rhythmic Gene Expression in *Brachypodium distachyon*.
ASPB Northeastern Section Meeting
Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Benjamin J. Cole, Chang Yu, Marie Remigereau, Tomás Duffy, Steve A. Kay and Samuel P. Hazen.

Posters

- 2019 Changes in ambient temperature are the prevailing cue in determining *Brachypodium distachyon* diurnal gene regulation.
Annual Symposium in Plant Biology
Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Benjamin J. Cole, Chang Yu, Joshua H. Coomey, Nolan T. Hartwick, Marie-Stanislas Remigereau, Tomás Duffy, Todd P. Michael, Steve A. Kay, Samuel P. Hazen.
- 2019 Exploring Diurnal Rhythmic Gene Expression in *Brachypodium distachyon*.
PAG XXVII
Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Benjamin J. Cole, Chang Yu, Marie Remigereau, Tomás Duffy, Steve A. Kay and Samuel P. Hazen.
- 2014 Daily Changes in Temperature, Not the Circadian Clock, Regulate Growth Rate in *Brachypodium distachyon*
UMass Undergraduate Research Symposium
Dominick A. Matos, Benjamin J. Cole, Ian P. Whitney, Kirk J.-M. MacKinnon, Steve A. Kay, Samuel P. Hazen.

Mentoring & Outreach

Train and mentor undergraduate assistants in the Hazen Lab

2020-2021 Sanyam Shilpakar.

2017-2019 Chang Yu.

2018-2019 Alden Nichols.

2018-2018 Jacob Scott.

2017-2017 Crysta Daniels.

Creation of online tools for data exploration

Timecourse RNA-seq

<https://hazenlab.shinyapps.io/shinyapp/>

Touch Responsive Timecourse RNA-seq

<https://hazenlab.shinyapps.io/swiztc/>

Gain and loss of function RNA-seq

<https://hazenlab.shinyapps.io/snd2r/>
